

Push 2 / Nuendo Bridge

Release Notes

Version 1.0.4 — May 2026

New Features

- **Channel Strip mode** (Mix → Mix again): a dedicated Channel Strip view with an overview page (Gate, Comp, EQ, Tools, Sat, Limiter shown as Cubase-coloured banners) and six drill-down sub-pages — one per module.
- **Strip slot extended parameters**: parameters that are NOT in Cubase's bank zone are now reachable via DirectAccess on every strip variant — e.g. VintageCompressor Ratio & Mix, Standard Compressor DryMix & Hold, Tube Compressor Character & High Ratio, DeEsser side-chain filter & Diff, Magneto II Dual & Oversample, Maximizer Release & Recover, Brickwall Link & Oversample, Noise Gate Hold & Analysis, and more.
- **EQ page (EQ-Eight style)**: band selector (Enc 1), Type / Freq / Q / Gain for the selected band, PreFilter Low-Cut / High-Cut frequency and on/off, PreGain, plus a live magnitude curve (4 EQ bands + PreFilter) with numbered band markers. The curve updates in real time from the Push **and** from changes made in Nuendo.
- **Edit Channel Settings**: now on lower-row button 8 (Channel Strip pages) and Shift+Upper Row (Mix view), in addition to the existing double-press. The button lights white and the on-screen pill turns white while the window is open (bidirectional state feedback).
- **Section colours & bold labels**: each Channel Strip section uses its Nuendo track-strip colour with bold module names, matching the Cubase/Nuendo GUI.
- **Amber Bypass indicators**: bypass pills/LEDs light amber when the section is bypassed (engaged), matching Nuendo's bypass button behaviour.
- **Lower-row LED sync**: lower-row button LEDs follow the on-screen toggle states on the Channel Strip overview and all sub-pages.
- **Piano scale mode**: a new *Piano* option in the Scale selector lays the pads out like a piano keyboard — white keys on the lower row of each octave pair, black keys on the upper row, four octaves stacked bottom-to-top, every C highlighted in purple. Rooted at C (root selection is locked in this mode); Octave Up/Down shifts the whole four-octave block.

Technical

- Strip slot DA exploration (up to 6 slots) with dynamic DA-slot resolution by plugin name — supports custom Cubase strip layouts where module order differs.
- DA param-flip mechanism (CC 73/74 ch8) for binary toggles that Cubase's setTypeToggle handles unreliably (e.g. VintageCompressor Punch, EQ section bypass, EQ band on/off).
- Live host-side parameter feedback via SysEx 0x3D from daInserts.mOnParameterChange, de-duplicated to avoid flooding during mouse drags in Nuendo.
- Edit Channel Settings window state via SysEx 0x3E (separate read binding).
- Dedicated read bindings for PreFilter Phase / section bypass and ChannelEQ bypass so the on-screen state stays in sync.

- SysEx range 0x34–0x3E and ch8 CC 70–78 allocated for strip slot cache, bypass, edit, param-flip, variant probe and live feedback.

Known Limitations

- **Windows — Push 2 cannot be used by the bridge and Ableton Live at the same time.** The Push 2 USB endpoint is exclusive: only one app can talk to it at a moment. Close one to use the other. On recent Live versions (12.x tested) the WinUSB driver Zadig installs works fine for Live as well, so no driver swap is needed in normal use. If you ever need to fully restore Ableton's original driver (older Live setups, or returning to a Live-only workflow), see *“Restoring the original driver”* in the Windows Installation Guide. (macOS is not affected.)
- Channel Strip modules must be **activated manually in Nuendo** first — an empty or disabled strip slot (Gate, Comp, EQ, Tools, Sat, Limiter) is not exposed to the Push 2. Load/enable the module in the Nuendo channel strip before controlling it from the controller.
- Strip slot **variant switching from the Push is not possible** — Cubase locks strip-slot plugin selection; the MIDI Remote API (trySetSlotPlugin / the slot 'Effect Type' tag) is silently rejected. Switch variants in Nuendo's strip-slot menu; the on-screen chip mirrors the active variant in real time.
- Opening a strip-slot plugin's **Edit UI from the Push is not exposed** by the MIDI Remote API (mEdit toggles a flag but Nuendo does not open the window). Use the 'e' button in the mixer console.
- ChannelEQ **bands 2 and 3 are always Peak** filters (Cubase restriction) — the Type encoder has no effect on those bands.
- No audio spectrogram behind the EQ curve — the MIDI Remote API provides no audio stream.
- **Remove the Push 2 'Live Port' and 'User Port' from Nuendo's “In All MIDI Inputs”** (Studio Setup → MIDI Port Setup) or pad notes will be doubled (one copy from the bridge's BridgeNotes port, one direct from the hardware).

Version 1.0.3 — April 2026

New Features

- **Plugin Browser** (Add Device button): browse and load plugins directly from the Push 2. Select an insert slot, scroll through your plugin collection, and load with one press. Uses the DirectAccess Plugin Manager API (Nuendo 15+ / API 1.3).
- **Collection cycling**: switch between Nuendo plugin collections via lower row button 1 in the plugin list view.
- **Plugin Mapper integration**: the Plugin Mapper web server (FastAPI) is now integrated into the bridge and starts automatically. Access it from the menu bar or at <http://localhost:8100>. Dependencies are optional.
- **DirectAccess insert control**: bypass, edit (open/close UI), and encoder parameter control via DirectAccess for instant response. Fallback to viewer-based control if DA is not available.
- **DA encoder control**: mapped plugin parameters controlled directly via DirectAccess on MIDI channel 9, with display value feedback.
- **Plugin Mapper fuzzy matching**: pedalboard parameter names matched to DA parameter names using word-level fuzzy matching.
- **Record button LED**: 3-state behavior — orange (idle), blinking red (track armed), solid red (recording).
- **Shift+Arrows nudge**: in Volume and Pan modes, Shift+Left/Right shifts the bank by 1 track instead of 8.
- **CC Mode pick-up** (Setup page): new CC Mode page with Absolute and Pick-up options. Pick-up mode prevents parameter jumps by waiting for a direction change before sending.
- **Adaptive text color**: track headers and title bars automatically switch between white and black text based on background luminance. Bold font for headers.
- **Splash screen updated**: removed IAC port reference. Now shows 'Load the MIDI Remote script in Nuendo'.

Technical

- Plugin list transfer via SysEx 0x2C/0x2D, queued in mOnIdle (10 entries/tick).
- Plugin load via CC 80-82 ch8 + trySetSlotPlugin (DA Plugin Manager API 1.3).
- Record state feedback via CC 73.
- Bank shift via CC 38/39 bound to mShiftRight/mShiftLeft.
- Plugin Mapper server in daemon thread with dedicated asyncio event loop.
- MIDI channels 8 (0xB7) and 9 (0xB8) allocated for DirectAccess.

Known Limitations

- No Effect (remove plugin) not supported — API 1.3 has no removeSlotPlugin.
- CC pick-up uses direction-change detection (no Nuendo feedback available).
- Plugin Browser requires Nuendo 15+ (API 1.3).

Version 1.0.2 — April 2026

- Setup Page with Aftertouch Mode and Velocity Curve settings.
- MIDI CC Controller page (Shift+Note): 8 assignable CC faders.
- Mute/Solo/Monitor/Rec on Device and Inserts pages.
- Long press / double press on upper row buttons.
- Clear Monitor / Clear Rec (Shift+Mute/Solo).

Version 1.0.1 — March 2026

- Volume stutter fix, peak clip grace period, Send 1 CC conflict fix, CR CC conflict fix, pan offset correction.

Version 1.0.0 — February 2026

- Initial release: Mixer, Sends, Device, Inserts, Transport, Automation, Control Room, Note Input, Touchstrip, Track Management, VU Meters, macOS Menu Bar App.